

Cloudflare Field Guide

Shadowed page rules, purges that clear nothing and Flexible SSL loops.

4 fixes, each one a written note with diagrams and a small Python and Node.js script that finds the problem and repairs it. All 4 have a script in the public repo.

Before you run anything. Every script starts in a dry run: it reports what it would change and writes nothing. Read that output first, then set `DRY_RUN=false` when you are satisfied it has understood your data.

Scripts: github.com/allanninal/cloudflare-fixes

Guides: allanninal.dev/cloudflare

All 14 repos: github.com/allanninal

The fixes

1 only one Page Rule applies, and it is the one at the top

You have a broad rule near the top that caches everything, and a specific rule further down that adds a redirect. Both patterns match the URL, so you expect both actions. You get one. Only the highest-priority matching Page Rule takes effect on a request — every other match is discarded, with no log line, no warning, and no indication in the dashboard that a rule was skipped.

[cloudflare_page_rule_shadow.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/cloudflare/only-one-page-rule-applies/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/cloudflare-fixes/tree/main/only-one-page-rule-applies>

2 a cache purge that reports success and clears nothing

You deployed, you purged the URL, the API returned `success: true`, and the old version is still being served. Purge by single file matches on the full cache key, not on the URL you typed. If the object was stored under a key that includes a header or a cookie, your purge request describes a different object — and clearing an object that does not exist is not an error, so the API says it worked.

[cloudflare_purge_verify.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/cloudflare/purge-by-url-silently-does-nothing/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/cloudflare-fixes/tree/main/purge-by-url-silently-does-nothing>

3 a Cloudflare rule that never applies because the record is grey-clouded

The redirect rule is right. The cache rule is right. You have re-read them four times and the syntax is fine. They never fire because the hostname they apply to is set to DNS only — the grey cloud — so requests go straight to your origin and never pass through Cloudflare at all. There is nothing wrong with the rule. Cloudflare is simply not in the path.

[cloudflare_proxy_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/cloudflare/rule-not-applying-record-not-proxied/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/cloudflare-fixes/tree/main/rule-not-applying-record-not-proxied>

4 ERR_TOO_MANY_REDIRECTS is almost always Flexible SSL

The site was fine yesterday. Now every request ends in ERR_TOO_MANY_REDIRECTS and the origin logs show the same request arriving over and over. Nothing changed on the server. What changed is that the origin started forcing HTTPS — a plugin, a new vhost, a security header — while Cloudflare is still set to Flexible, which means it talks to the origin over plain HTTP. The origin redirects to HTTPS, Cloudflare answers that redirect, and the two of them loop until the browser gives up.

[cloudflare_ssl_mode_check.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/cloudflare/too-many-redirects-flexible-ssl/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/cloudflare-fixes/tree/main/too-many-redirects-flexible-ssl>
